

Basic Syntax in Java

Get personalized course recommendations

Answer a few quick questions about your interests and skill level. We'll create a custom list of courses just for you.

[Take the quiz](#)

Comments

There are two types of comments in Java: inline, and block.

```
// This is an inline comment. It only
includes this line.

/*
  This is a block comment. Anything
  between the asterisks is part of the
  comment.
*/
```

Printing

In Java, you can print statements using `System.out.print()` and `System.out.println()`. The latter ends with a new line.

```
System.out.print("I'm first!");
System.out.println("I'm second!");
System.out.print("I'm last!");

/* Prints:
I'm first!I'm second!
I'm last!
*/
```

Methods

A method is a modular, reusable block of code that can be called throughout a program to complete a certain task.

```
/*  
The following method is a public method  
called findSum. The method takes in two  
int parameters called int1 and int2. This  
method returns an int value.  
*/  
public static int findSum(int num1, int  
num2) {  
    return num1 + num2;  
}  
  
public static void main(String[] args) {  
    // Call the method with the arguments 3  
and 4  
    int sum = findSum(3,4);  
    System.out.println(sum); // Prints: 7  
}
```

Variable Types

Variables are used to name, store, and reference different types of data.

Primitive data types are predefined types of data and include `int`, `double`, `boolean`, and `char`.

Reference data types contain references to an object.

An example reference data type is `String`.

```
// int - stores whole numbers:  
int num = 10;  
  
// double - stores decimal numbers:  
double dec = 4.99;  
  
// boolean - stores true or false values:  
boolean isTrue = true;  
  
// char - stores a single character  
value:  
char firstLetter = 'A';  
  
// String - stores multiple characters:  
String message = "hello there";
```

Manipulating Number Variables

Different math operations can be applied to `int`, `double`, and `float` data types.

```
int a = 3;
int b = 5;

int num1;
num1 = a + a; // num1 now equals 6
num1 = a - b; // num1 now equals -2
num1 = a * b; // num1 now equals 15
num1 = 9 / a; // num1 now equals 3
num1 = 10 % a; // num1 now equals 1

int num2 = 10;
num2 -= a; // num2 now equals 8
num2 += b; // num2 now equals 13
num2 %= 6; // num2 now equals 1
num2 *= 4; // num2 now equals 4
num2 /= 2; // num2 now equals 2

int num3 = 3;
num3++; // num3 now equals 4
num3--; // num3 now equals 3
```

Conditional Statements

In Java, conditional statements execute code based on the truth value of given `boolean` expressions.

```
boolean expression1 = false;
boolean expression2 = false;
boolean expression3 = true;

if (expression1) {
    System.out.println("The first
expression is true");
} else if (expression2) {
    System.out.println("The second
expression is true");
} else if (expression3) {
    System.out.println("The third
expression is true");
} else {
    System.out.println("All other
expressions were false");
}

// Prints: The third expression is true
```

Comparison and Logical Operators

Conditional operators and logical operators evaluate the relationship between values in order to determine a `true` or `false` value.

```
// Comparison Operators:
int a = 1;
int b = 5;
System.out.println(a > b); // Prints:
false
System.out.println(a < b); // Prints:
true
System.out.println(a >= 1); // Prints:
true
System.out.println(a + 4 <= b); //
Prints: true
System.out.println(a == 1); // Prints:
true
System.out.println(b != 5); // Prints:
false

// Logical Operators:
System.out.println(!true); // Prints:
false
System.out.println(!false); // Prints:
true

System.out.println(true && true); //
Prints: true
System.out.println(true && false); //
Prints: false
System.out.println(false && true); //
Prints: false
System.out.println(false && false); //
Prints: false

System.out.println(true || true); //
Prints: true
System.out.println(true || false); //
Prints: true
System.out.println(false || true); //
Prints: true
System.out.println(false || false); //
Prints: false
```

String Methods

Java's `String` class has many useful methods including:

- `.length()`, which returns the length of the `String`
- `.concat()`, which concatenates two `String`s together
- `.equals()`, which checks for `String` equality
- `.indexOf()`, which returns the index of the first occurrence of a specified character
- `.charAt()`, which returns the character at a specified index
- `.substring()`, which extracts a substring

```
// Using the .length() method:  
String str = "Hello World!";  
System.out.println(str.length()); //  
Prints: 12
```

```
// Using the .concat() method:  
String name = "Code";  
name = name.concat("cademy");  
System.out.println(name); // Prints:  
Codecademy
```

```
// Using the .equals() method:  
String flavor1 = "Mango";  
String flavor2 = "Matcha";  
System.out.println(flavor1.equals(flavor2  
)); // Prints: false
```

```
// Using the .indexOf() method:  
String letters = "ABCDEFGHIIJKLMN";  
System.out.println(letters.indexOf("C"));  
// Prints: 2
```

```
// Using the .charAt() method:  
String currency = "Yen";  
System.out.println(currency.charAt(2));  
// Prints: n
```

```
// Using the .substring() method  
String line = "It was the best of times,  
it was the worst of times."  
System.out.println(line.substring(26));  
// Prints: it was the worst of times.  
System.out.println(line.substring(7,  
24)); // Prints: the best of times
```

Loops

Java has four kinds of loops that rely on a **boolean** condition and continue to iterate until the condition is no longer true:

- **while** loops
- **do-while** loops
- **for** loops
- **for-each** loops

```
// An example of a while loop:
int x = 0;
while (x < 2) {
    System.out.println(x);
    x++;
} // Prints: 0 and 1

// An example of a do-while loop:
do {
    System.out.println("Impossible!");
} while (2 == 4); // Prints: Impossible!

// An example of a for loop:
for (int i = 0; i < 10; i++) {
    System.out.println(i);
} // Prints: 0 to 9, inclusive

// An example of a for-each loop:
String[] colors = {"Red", "Blue", "Yellow"};
for (String c : colors) {
    System.out.println(c);
} // Prints: Red, Blue, and Yellow
```

break and continue

Java has two keywords that help further control the number of iterations in a loop:

- **break** is used to exit, or break, a loop. Once **break** is executed, the loop will stop iterating.
- **continue** can be placed inside of a loop if we want to skip an iteration. If **continue** is executed, the current loop iteration will immediately end, and the next iteration will begin.

```
// An example of a break statement:
for (int i = 0; i < 10; i++) {
    System.out.println(i);
    if (i == 4) {
        break;
    }
} // Prints: 0 to 4, inclusive

// An example of a continue statement:
int[] numbers = {1, 2, 3, 4, 5};
for (int i = 0; i < numbers.length; i++)
{
    if (numbers[i] % 2 == 0) {
        continue;
    }
    System.out.println(numbers[i]);
} // Prints 1, 3, and 5
```